

Dono Refund and Dispute Policy · Dono

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Version 3.0 · Effective 7 August 2026 **Document type:** Contractual
Supersedes version 2.3 (6 August 2026) and all earlier versions.

Precedence: This Policy governs all refund, surplus, dispute and chargeback matters. Where any other Dono document touches those subjects, this Policy prevails (Terms of Service clause 1.7).

1. Read this first

1.1 Dono does not hold your money. Your Donation goes directly into the Recipient's own Stripe connected account. Dono holds no payment account and never receives, holds, safeguards or controls the donation itself. Dono takes only its fee.

1.2 Dono decides whether a refund is due — and may execute it. Dono determines whether, under the Platform's rules, a refund is required, in what amount, and what remedy is appropriate. That refund is paid out of the Recipient's own Stripe account, either because the Recipient executes it or because **Dono instructs the Payment Provider to reverse the charge under the authority every Campaign Owner and Recipient grants when they accept the Terms of Service** (clause 13.2). Dono acts as their agent for that limited purpose and for no other.

1.3 What Dono still cannot do. Dono cannot recall money already paid out and spent. Dono cannot hold, delay or divert a payout. Dono holds no reserve and **never pays refunds from its own funds** — apart from reversing its own fee. Dono's insurance does not fund or guarantee refunds. A refund can only be executed to the extent the Connected Account has, or later receives, sufficient funds; executing against an insufficient balance may create a negative balance for which the Recipient is responsible to the Payment Provider.

1.3A A practical point about timing. Under the Payment Provider's current settings, money is not paid out of the Connected Account to the Recipient's bank the moment a Donation is made — there is a short delay first, and payouts then run on a schedule. **A refund raised promptly is therefore more likely to succeed than one raised weeks later.** This is a description of the Payment Provider's configuration, which may change; it is not a guarantee, and it does not mean Dono can hold the money.

1.4 Each Donation creates a direct contract between the Donor and the Campaign Owner about the use of the funds and any refund obligations.

That contract is formed when the Payment Provider confirms the payment has succeeded (Terms of Service clause 12.2). Dono is not a party to it.

1.5 Nothing here removes your statutory rights, your rights against your card issuer, or your rights under the Payment Provider's terms.

2. Two different routes

2.1 A **refund request** goes to Dono, which investigates and determines whether a refund is due; the refund is then executed from the Recipient's account under clause 6. A **chargeback** goes to your bank or card issuer, which decides under card-scheme rules; Dono supplies evidence and cannot stop it.

2.2 **Please contact Dono first.** In most cases we can investigate and arrange a refund more quickly than a card dispute. Using Dono's process does not prevent a later chargeback, and **using a lawful chargeback does not breach these Terms.** This is guidance, not a restriction. Our 21-day target may consume part of your issuer's chargeback window; if timing matters, check your issuer's deadlines.

2.3 Give accurate information in any refund request or chargeback. Knowingly making a false or fraudulent claim may result in suspension and other appropriate action.

3. Grounds for a refund

3.1 **Every ground in this clause stands on its own.** If the ground is made out, a refund is available. **A Donor never has to show that the matter was material to their decision to donate, that they relied on it, or that it caused the campaign's outcome.** Proportionality is relevant only to **how much** is refunded (clause 4.3), never to whether a refund is available at all.

3.2 Transactional grounds.

(a) duplicate payment; (b) payment error, including a charge for the wrong amount; (c) unauthorised payment; (d) a Donation made by a person under 18; (e) cancellation of the Campaign before the money is spent; (f) failure or withdrawal of the Campaign Owner's eligibility, where the Campaign should not have been published; and (g) Surplus Funds falling to be refunded under clause 10.

3.3 Conduct and purpose grounds. Each of the following **independently justifies a refund**:

(a) **fraud** by the Campaign Owner or anyone acting for them; (b) **misuse of funds** — applying Campaign funds to anything outside the stated purpose, or to a purpose not strongly related to it; (c) **a material change made without authorisation**, including a change implemented before it was submitted to Dono, and a change made after funds were spent in order to

regularise that spending; (d) **failure to provide mandatory evidence** — receipts, updates or a Closure Statement — after Dono has given a reasonable opportunity to put it right and the cure period has expired; (e) **inability to use the funds for the stated purpose**, whatever the reason; (f) **material misrepresentation** in the Campaign or in any update; and (g) **failure to proceed** where funds should be returned.

3.4 Spending in breach of the restriction in clause 14.4 of the Terms of Service — spending affected funds before a refund window closes — is itself misuse of funds under clause 3.3(b).

3.5 Not grounds on their own: disappointment with the outcome; a Project attempted honestly that did not succeed; a change of mind; or the target not being met where the money can still be used meaningfully for the stated purpose. Campaigns describe the **intended** use of funds; they are not promises of a result.

3.6 More than one ground may apply. Where a request engages several, all are considered; the reviewer does not have to choose one.

4. Decision framework

4.1 Decisions are made on the **balance of probabilities**, on the evidence actually available — campaign content as it appeared at the time of donation, updates, evidence submitted, Payment Provider records and any response from the Campaign Owner — not on assumption.

4.2 No materiality or causation test. Clause 3.1 applies to every ground. A Campaign Owner cannot defeat a refund by arguing that the Donor would have given anyway.

4.3 Amount. Dono may decide on a full refund, a partial refund or no refund. **Proportionality applies only here.** A partial refund reflects the proportion of the Donation affected: where part of a Campaign proceeded as described and part did not, the refund is the proportion attributable to the part that did not, and the reasoning is recorded. **But where funds were used for something outside the stated purpose, or a purpose not strongly related to it, the whole of the affected amount is refundable — there is no de minimis and no allowance for small deviations.** Cases of shared responsibility are apportioned. Similar cases are decided consistently.

4.4 Conflicts of interest. Anyone involved in a dispute, who knows a party personally, or who donated to, shared or promoted the Campaign, must declare it and take no part in deciding it. The recusal is recorded with the case.

5. Time, completeness and process

5.1 A request is submitted through the Platform or by email to joindono.team@gmail.com, with a reason and any supporting material. A

request is **complete** once Dono has the information reasonably required to assess it; where more is needed, Dono will normally identify everything it reasonably requires in a **single** request.

5.2 Time limits (for Dono's voluntary internal process only; they do not shorten legal rights): an ordinary request within **60 days** after the Campaign End Date, or after the Donor became aware of the matter, whichever is later; a fraud or deliberate-misrepresentation request up to **12 months** after the Donation. Dono may accept late cases where fair.

5.3 Timescales. Dono aims to acknowledge within **two Working Days** and decides within **21 calendar days** of receiving a complete request, extendable **once by up to a further 21 calendar days** where complexity or delay in obtaining information makes that necessary, with reasons and an updated expected date. **External deadlines — card-scheme chargeback windows, statutory limitation periods and any other external deadline — continue independently of Dono's process, and Dono tells both parties so.**

5.4 Notice to the Campaign Owner. Dono notifies the Connected Account holder immediately when a refund request is received, tells them the substance of the allegation, shows them the evidence relied on, and gives them **ten Working Days** to respond — extendable on reasonable request where they are unwell, on holiday, sitting examinations or otherwise genuinely unable to respond. Urgent interim measures may be taken where there is a genuine and immediate risk. No adverse inference is drawn unless the Campaign Owner received the notice and had a fair opportunity to respond.

5.5 Identity. Where the Donor hid their name, Dono withholds their identity from the Campaign Owner and does not disclose it as a dispute-resolution step. Disclosure occurs only where required or permitted by law, following clause 25 of the Terms of Service. This does not affect what the Payment Provider separately shows the Connected Account holder; the Campaign Terms prohibit using that information to identify, contact or pressure a Donor.

5.6 Both parties receive the outcome and reasons. An appeal may be brought within ten Working Days of being notified, under clause 8 of the Community Guidelines, and is decided by someone who was not substantially involved in the original decision. The appeal is Dono's final internal decision and does not affect statutory, card-issuer or legal rights.

6. How an approved refund is executed

6.1 Two routes, one outcome.

(a) **The Recipient executes it.** A Campaign Owner notified that a refund is required is contractually obliged to execute it promptly from their own Stripe dashboard. Failure is a breach and a ground for enforcement under Part 9 of the Terms of Service. (b) **Dono executes it under the refund mandate.** Where the Recipient does not execute the refund promptly, or

where Dono considers it necessary to do so, **Dono may instruct the Payment Provider to reverse the charge, in whole or in part, from the Connected Account**, acting as the Campaign Owner's and Recipient's authorised agent under clause 13.2 of the Terms of Service. Dono uses this authority only for refunds determined under this Policy, and never to move money to itself.

6.2 **Before Dono executes.** Dono will:

(a) confirm that the determination has been made and recorded; (b) confirm that the Connected Account holder has been notified and given the opportunity to respond under clause 5.4 — **except** where the Donation must be reversed urgently to prevent fraud, an unauthorised payment or harm; (c) **check the transaction's dispute state and confirm that no chargeback or card-network dispute is already open or already resolved in the Donor's favour** (clause 8.4); and (d) record the decision, the amount, the authorising person and the time.

6.3 **After Dono executes.** Dono records the Payment Provider's refund reference, the amount, the date and the outcome; notifies the Donor and the Connected Account holder; updates the transaction's dispute state; and retains the record as evidence.

6.4 **Appeal after execution.** A Campaign Owner may appeal the determination within ten Working Days of being notified. Because the refund may already have been executed, a successful appeal results in correction of the record and, where appropriate, restoration of Dono's fee and any other step within Dono's power. **Dono does not undertake to reverse a completed refund**, and any recovery from the Donor is a matter between the Donor and the Campaign Owner.

6.5 **Insufficient funds.** A refund may be delayed or fail where the Connected Account holds insufficient funds. **Dono does not make up the difference.** The Campaign Owner remains contractually liable to the Donor.

6.6 **Refunds and exchange rates.** A refund returns the sterling amount donated; a non-UK card issuer converts it back at the refund-day rate, so the sum received in the Donor's currency may differ slightly. Neither Dono nor the Campaign Owner controls that rate or receives any part of an issuer charge.

7. If the Campaign Owner does not cooperate

7.1 Where a refund is due and is not executed, Dono may, in escalating order: execute the refund itself under clause 6.1(b); suspend or remove the Campaign; suspend or permanently ban the account; prevent future fundraising on Dono; refer deliberate misuse to the Recognised Institution under the **Institutional Referral Protocol**; support the Donor's chargeback by assembling the evidence Dono holds; and report suspected fraud to the police or another authority.

7.2 Dono cannot withhold, delay or divert a payout. Dono has no ability to hold funds in, or release funds from, a Connected Account, and claims no such power.

7.3 Dono does not pursue debt collection and does not guarantee recovery. The Campaign Owner remains contractually liable to the Donor, who may pursue chargeback, Payment Provider or legal remedies.

8. Chargebacks, disputes and coordination

8.1 A chargeback is decided by the Donor's card issuer under card-scheme rules. Neither Dono nor the Payment Provider makes the substantive decision, and Dono cannot prevent or reverse one.

8.2 Under the live configuration: the Connected Account bears the chargeback, is charged the Payment Provider's dispute fee, and **owns the dispute** — the Connected Account holder is the party who submits evidence. Where a negative balance cannot be recovered from the Connected Account, the Payment Provider is the losses collector under Dono's configuration and absorbs the unrecoverable remainder.

8.3 Dono's role in a dispute is to assist, not to decide or to submit on the Campaign Owner's behalf. Dono provides the records it holds — the campaign page as it appeared at the time of donation, the donation-time disclosures, evidence submitted, correspondence, the refund determination and its reasons — promptly, so that the Connected Account holder can submit them.

8.4 One dispute state per Donation. Every Donation carries a **single dispute state** recording refund requests, card-network disputes and chargebacks, and completed refunds, so that all three are coordinated rather than handled separately. Under that system:

(a) **Dono notifies the Connected Account holder immediately** when a refund request is received and when Dono becomes aware that a chargeback or dispute has been opened; (b) **Dono alerts the Connected Account holder before the card-network response deadline**, with the deadline stated; (c) **Dono checks the dispute state before executing any refund** and does not execute one where a chargeback is already open or already resolved in the Donor's favour; (d) where a refund has already been executed and a chargeback is subsequently opened, Dono records the completed refund and supplies the evidence of it; and (e) **Dono records evidence of every completed refund** against the transaction.

8.5 No double recovery. If a Donor both receives a refund and succeeds in a chargeback for the same Donation, the duplicate amount is repayable. The Donor must notify Dono promptly on becoming aware of a duplicate recovery, and Dono, the Campaign Owner and the Recipient may each take reasonable steps to recover it, including by set-off against any other amount due to that Donor. The Campaign Owner must likewise notify Dono promptly if they become aware of a duplicate recovery.

9. Fees on a refund

9.1 Dono's fee is the schedule fixed for the Campaign: **2% + 20p for a beta/demo Campaign** or **5% + 20p for a production Campaign**, collected as the Payment Provider's application fee. It is separate from the Payment Provider's processing cost, which is charged to the Connected Account. During demo it is described as **"Payment processing fee (Dono)"**.

9.2 **Dono reverses its own fee where a refund is due and the Donor was not at fault.** Where a Campaign cannot proceed, or the Campaign Owner caused the refund through mistake, breach or misrepresentation, the Donor receives Dono's fee back and the Campaign Owner bears the economic cost so far as technically possible. Where the Donor caused the refund through their own error, Dono's fee is not reversed. On a partial refund, Dono's fee is reversed **proportionately** where the Donor was not at fault. **Any fee-cover amount the Donor paid is returned on the same basis.**

9.3 **Mechanically there are two separate movements.** First, the charge is refunded from the Connected Account — the Donor's contribution coming back. Second, **Dono reverses its application fee through the Payment Provider's application-fee mechanism**, proportionately on a partial refund; that is a reduction of Dono's own revenue. **The Payment Provider's processing cost is generally not returned on a refund and is borne by the Connected Account.** Dono is not VAT registered, so no VAT adjustment or credit note arises; if Dono registers, it will make the corresponding output-VAT adjustment and issue any required credit note.

10. Failed, cancelled and partially funded Campaigns; surplus

10.1 Not reaching target does not automatically cancel a Project; the Campaign Owner decides whether it can still proceed meaningfully, otherwise refunds are arranged. A Campaign cancelled before the money is spent is refunded.

10.2 **Surplus — no de minimis.** Any amount that cannot reasonably be used for the stated purpose must be refunded. **There is no threshold below which surplus may be kept.** Every penny of unused money is refundable, and Campaign Owners are told to request an accurate amount at the outset rather than rely on a residual allowance.

10.3 **How surplus is allocated.** Two mechanisms operate together.

(a) **Automatic allocation.** Dono refunds surplus in **reverse chronological order** — the most recent Donor first, up to the amount they donated, then the next, until the surplus is exhausted. **Surplus is not distributed proportionately** and no Donor is guaranteed an automatic share. This is disclosed at checkout before the Donor pays, and again in the Closure Statement. (b) **Individual right to claim. Independently of (a), any**

Donor to a Campaign with unused funds may request a refund of their share of those funds under clause 3.3(e), whether or not the automatic allocation has reached them. Their claim is decided under clauses 4 and 5 in the ordinary way. (c) **One ledger.** Dono maintains a ledger of every surplus refund and its order, so that **no amount is refunded twice** and the total refunded never exceeds the surplus.

10.4 Over-funding. A Campaign cannot be funded beyond its target, so over-funding does not arise. **Any over-payment is refunded in full.**

11. Evidence, updates and closure

11.1 Campaign Owners declare expected purchase dates, submit receipts privately within 14 days of expenditure, redact unnecessary personal data before uploading, provide updates, and submit a Closure Statement under clause 10.3 of the Terms of Service: 30-day submission with reminders, defined contents, 30-day review against a reviewer checklist, limited rejection grounds, **one cure cycle**, and **administrative closure** where Dono does not decide in time. **Administrative closure is labelled as procedural, is not a finding that the Campaign Owner complied**, and does not prejudice a Donor's refund rights.

11.2 Donors see a neutral lifecycle state only. **Failure to provide mandatory evidence after a cure period, and failure to submit a Closure Statement after reminders, are standalone refund grounds under clause 3.3(d)** and grounds for enforcement.

12. Complaints and records

12.1 A refund request is one kind of complaint. Complaints about **how** a refund request was handled — as opposed to how it was decided — and about account suspension, campaign removal, verification, technical issues, moderation or fees are dealt with under the Complaints Policy and, for content and moderation, clause 8 of the Community Guidelines. All routes use the same address: joindono.team@gmail.com.

12.2 **Records.** Dono retains refund and dispute records — requests, evidence, decisions, reasons, appeals, escalation, dispute states and completed-refund evidence — and receipts and evidence of expenditure, in accordance with the **Retention Schedule** in the Privacy Notice. Refund and dispute records and uploaded expenditure evidence are retained for **six years** from case closure or campaign completion, reflecting the limitation period for contract claims in England and Wales.

12.3 Contact: joindono.team@gmail.com. Dono is a trading name of Amrit Kaur Rooprai, a sole trader, 37 St Giles', Oxford OX1 3LD.